

SAAD AHMAD - ACCA

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Strategic, results driven finance leader with **18+ years' experience** across manufacturing, technology, telecoms and services, spanning startups to multinational organisations across the EMEA. Proven track record in board level business partnering, FP&A, governance, and financial transformation, delivering measurable improvements in profitability, cashflow and control. Experienced in leading finance functions through ERP and organisational change, strengthening accountability, and enabling data led decision making. Trusted adviser to MDs and Boards, combining commercial insight with strong regulatory and risk discipline.

FINANCE DIRECTOR / CFO VALUE PROPOSITION

- **Strategic Leadership & Business Partnering** – Board and executive decision support; translating operational performance into financial outcomes
 - **Performance Management (FP&A)** – Budgeting, forecasting, KPI frameworks, margin and revenue channel analysis
 - **Governance, Risk & Compliance** – Internal controls, audits, fraud detection, IFRS, VAT and corporation tax
 - **Cash, Treasury & Investment** – Working capital optimisation, FX exposure, capital investment and funding
 - **Transformation & Systems** – ERP leadership (SAP, MS Dynamics, SAGE), automation and data integration
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KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Secured £26m in asset funding through a consortium-based financing structure
 - Delivered tax planning resulting in £0.8m recovery from HMRC
 - Strengthened internal controls, halving data input errors and supporting 22% YoY sales growth (£8 m)
 - Restructured operating costs, delivering £1.2m recurring annual savings
 - Identified and recovered £280k of revenue leakage through forensic review and remediation
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Finance Director – Mondi Birmingham Ltd | UK

Jan 2022 – Present

Leading the finance function of a manufacturing business within a multinational group, partnering with the MD and Board to drive financial performance, governance and strategic execution. Joined as Head of finance and was promoted to FD.

Key contributions

- Led the financial merger of the business and subsequent integration with Mondi group.
- Restructured the finance team and streamlined month end close, reporting and controls reducing monthly closing from Day 9 to Day 3
- Built a robust monthly management accounts and forecasting pack
- Aligned to group consolidation, investment planning and Forex account management for group.
- Oversaw consolidation and intercompany mismatches reviewing controls and training finance team.
- Prepared and Managed CAPEX budget with treasury and funding management to secure assets worth 30+ million.
- Created a stock valuation system reporting costs and ageing which was later transferred to formal software
- Translated financial variances into operational drivers, risks and corrective actions with KPI's to track
- Led the treasury department and created a cashflow forecast for up to 15 weeks.
- Led annual budgets and medium term plans (2022–2026), embedding daily operational KPIs
- Led finance workstreams for ERP, supply chain and Payroll & HR system transformations
- Integrated ERP, MS Dynamics and Linux systems via APIs to improve data integrity and efficiency
- Oversaw VAT, corporation tax, statutory accounts and external audits
- Led accounts receivable and payable and re-wrote policies resulting surplus funds
- Reviewed the VFM process with supply chain department and introduced further controls
- We worked the commercial costing methodology and created a costing system that help the business win tenders more than £5M
- Presented monthly briefs to all staff and group management detailing financial performance and impact of decisions of incomes and expenses
- Led the conversion of Financial Statements to IFRS from UK GAAP and subsequent publishing.
- Achieved clean audits throughout the tenure.

Management Accountant – Q Care Ltd | UK**Dec 2019 – Dec 2021**

Senior finance role reporting to the MD and operating as part of the strategic management team.

Key contributions

- Produced monthly management accounts with actionable insight for the MD and SMT
 - Delivered GP, margin and cost analysis with board ready reporting packs
 - Built P&L reporting by service run, significantly improving operational visibility
 - Delivered cost management training for operational managers, embedding financial ownership
 - Improved payroll and finance processes, releasing time and cost efficiencies
 - Worked with ERP providers to unlock under used data, delivering £200k savings
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Finance Manager – Trakker Middle East | Dubai**Feb 2018 – Aug 2019**

Managed a finance team of 10 within a technology and finance solutions provider serving enterprise and government clients.

Key contributions

- Financial oversight for large enterprise clients including ADNOC and OPAL
 - Implemented cost reduction initiatives delivering 10% annual cost of sales savings
 - Designed a bespoke ERP finance module and secured \$250k low risk development funding
 - Owned IFRS reporting, VAT, audit coordination and Board reporting
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Finance Manager – N.E.T.S | Dubai**Feb 2016 – Jan 2018**

Promoted from project accountant to finance manager within a civil construction group.

Key contributions

- Built financial models covering funding scenarios, ROI and project risk
 - Delivered cost benefit analysis and investment appraisals
 - Applied forensic accounting techniques to uncover control weaknesses and prevent recurrence
 - Tracked financial performance across a \$500m construction project portfolio
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Senior Accounts Officer – Embassy of Libya**Jul 2012 – Dec 2015**

Finance role within a diplomatic and high governance environment.

- Managed financial liaison with senior government officials and diplomats
 - Maintained strict document control and custody of sensitive financial records
 - Managed budgeting, AR/AP, fixed assets, cash, payroll and general ledger
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Senior Credit Controller – Tecman | Islamabad**Nov 2010 – May 2012**

- Managed high volume customer ledger and legal recovery actions
 - Ran monthly credit reviews and bank reconciliations
 - Set team targets and negotiated repayment plans
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Accounts Officer – Ufone (PTML) | Islamabad**Jan 2008 – Oct 2010**

- Supported nationwide revenue and franchise performance analysis
 - Worked with developers to enhance reporting through PL/SQL interfaces
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Audit Associate – KPMG | Islamabad**Jan 2007 – Dec 2007**

- Supported statutory audits for multi million dollar clients across investment, telecoms and regulatory sectors
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EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

- ACCA (UK) Member
 - BSc (Hons) Applied Accounting – Oxford Brookes University
 - CAT – ACCA
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SYSTEMS & TOOLS

SAP R/3, S4 | MS Dynamics | Business Central | Excel (Advanced) | Sage 50 | JD Edwards | Tally | Oracle | Xero

TRAININGS

Office 365 – RMS - Microsoft Learning Partner
Oracle Hyperion - Oracle
SAP ERP/FMS – Ufone PTML
Commerce Strategy – Goal Intl
Certified Mentor: B2B Products – Etisalat
Financial Instruments – Efu Insurance
Advance Excel – Goal Intl
MS Dynamics – Azzure IT
Sage 50 Cloud – Sage
MS Business Central Accounting – Advania
SAP S4 Hanna - SAP

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Nationality: British
- Languages: English, Urdu, Punjabi, Arabic (basic)
- Driving Licences: UK, UAE, KSA
- Notice Period: 6 months (Negotiable)